Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Saturday, 24 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Rain	Rain	Rain	Rain
16° 8°	14° 7°	13° 8°	12° 4°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, has released a statement regarding 'disturbing allegations' against her father, Thomas Markle.**

This follows reports that her estranged father is reportedly being investigated over child sex abuse images in the Philippines. The Duchess was informed about these allegations back in 2018.

ROYAL NEWS · UK

2 **Scientists are hailing a potential turning point in cancer treatment after the first personalised cancer vaccine cut the risk of the disease returning in a major trial.**

The results bring personalised medicine a significant step closer, offering new hope for many. This groundbreaking research could transform how we approach cancer care.

HEALTH · UK

3 **A detective who was raped by a colleague has described the Metropolitan Police's handling of her case as 'like being raped again'.**

Linda Williams was attacked by David Carrick, who was jailed in 2023 for sexual offences against 12 women. Her powerful statement highlights serious concerns about how the force supports its own officers.

CRIME · UK

4 **A former Conservative campaign chief and his wife have received suspended sentences over election betting.**

Anthony Lee passed confidential information to his wife, Laura Lee, regarding the date of the 2024 general election. This political betting scandal has led to their convictions.

POLITICS · UK

5 **A trial date has been set for two Iranian men accused of plotting to bomb a synagogue and a museum in the UK.**

The men are alleged to have identified Heaton Park Synagogue and the Jewish Museum as potential targets. This serious case highlights ongoing security concerns.

CRIME · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **The rumour mill is in overdrive as reports suggest the final screen tests for the next James Bond are happening this weekend!**

Callum Turner and Jack Lowden are apparently among those in the mix to take on the iconic 007 role. It won't be long until we find out who will be ordering that martini.

ON AIR — Who would you like to see as the next James Bond? Is there anyone else you think should be in the running?

FILM · COMING SOON

2 **Wales has its first UK number one single in 15 years, thanks to singer Jamie Miller!**

His track 'Babydoll' has topped the charts, making him the first Welsh artist to achieve this since Sian Evans' feature on DJ Fresh's 'Louder' in 2011. A fantastic achievement for Welsh music!

ON AIR — What's your favourite number one single from a Welsh artist? Do you remember Sian Evans' hit?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

3 **The much-loved musical 'Matilda' is celebrating a fantastic 15 years as a West End success story!**

The show, which began its journey in Stratford-upon-Avon, has now been seen by over 12 million people worldwide. It continues to be a huge hit with audiences of all ages.

ON AIR — Have you seen 'Matilda the Musical'? What's your favourite West End show that's been running for years?

THEATRE · ANNIVERSARY

4 **Gamers are excited as 'Call of Duty' promises a return to form with its latest release, 'Modern Warfare 4'.**

After last year's game reportedly missed the mark with fans, there's high hopes for this new instalment. However, it faces stiff competition from the ever-popular 'Grand Theft Auto' series.

ON AIR — Are you a Call of Duty fan, or do you prefer Grand Theft Auto? What's your go-to video game?

GAMING · NEW RELEASE

5 **Slade legend Dave Hill is set to release his debut solo album, paying tribute to his Wolverhampton roots!**

The album celebrates his hometown and shares personal stories from his incredible career. It's a chance to hear a new side of a true rock icon.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Slade song? Are you looking forward to hearing Dave Hill's solo work?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Concerning news from Germany: Bayern Munich manager Vincent Kompany has been taken to hospital after collapsing at training.**

Kompany collapsed on Friday while watching the club's second team train. We're all hoping for a swift and full recovery for the former Manchester City captain.

ON AIR — It's always worrying when something like this happens in sport. What are your thoughts on the pressures managers face?

FOOTBALL · EUROPE

2 **Arsenal fans are facing a nervous wait, with fears that star forward Bukayo Saka could be sidelined for up to two months.**

Saka suffered a quadriceps injury during the recent match against Bayern Munich. This would be a huge blow for the Gunners as they push for silverware.

ON AIR — How big a miss would Bukayo Saka be for Arsenal? Do you think they have the squad depth to cope?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Michael Carrick has given an emotional, five-minute address about what Manchester United means to him, but refused to rule out dropping Bruno Fernandes.**

The United manager spoke candidly at a media briefing, highlighting the deep connection he has with the club. His comments about Fernandes will certainly spark debate among fans.

ON AIR — Do you think Bruno Fernandes should be dropped from the Manchester United starting eleven? What's your take on Carrick's emotional speech?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **It was a tough day for Wales at the Women's Rugby League World Cup as Samoa ran riot, inflicting a heavy 76-0 defeat.**

Samoa scored 14 unanswered tries to secure their first win in Pool A, leaving Wales with two defeats from two matches. A dominant performance from Samoa.

ON AIR — What do you think Wales needs to do to bounce back from such a significant defeat? Can they still turn their World Cup around?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

5 **Golfer Ian Poulter has announced he is leaving LIV Golf, continuing the exodus of big names from the tour.**

Poulter stated he wants to focus on helping his sons become professional golfers and developing his YouTube channel. It marks a new chapter for the Ryder Cup legend.

ON AIR — What do you make of players leaving LIV Golf? Do you think we'll see more big names return to the traditional tours?

GOLF · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new trend is seeing people find joy in 'curating their perfect snack drawer' at home.**
It seems the humble snack drawer is getting a makeover, with many taking pride in arranging their treats by type, colour, or even 'mood'. It's all about creating a delightful little edible sanctuary.

2 **Research suggests that the gentle 'thrum of a distant washing machine' can be surprisingly comforting.**
For some, this subtle background hum provides a sense of a productive home without being disruptive, almost like a domestic white noise. It's a small, reassuring presence.

3 **Many are rediscovering the simple pleasure of 'writing a physical shopping list' with a pen and paper.**
In an age of digital notes, the tactile act of scribbling down groceries is making a comeback. People report it feels more mindful and helps them remember items better.

4 **The satisfying 'clink of ice cubes' dropping into a freshly poured drink is being celebrated as a small sensory delight.**
Whether it's for a soft drink or a refreshing cordial, that distinct sound signals the start of a cooling moment. It's a tiny acoustic treat.

5 **A surprising number of people admit to 'talking to their houseplants' as a regular, calming ritual.**
From encouraging new growth to simply saying hello, these quiet conversations offer a moment of connection and often make people feel more settled. And who knows, perhaps the plants enjoy it too!

6 **Experts are noting a rise in the trend of 'perfectly stacking cushions' on the sofa after tidying.**
It's a small, often subconscious act of domestic order, providing a sense of completion and a visually pleasing start to relaxation. A tidy sofa, a tidy mind!

7 **The simple act of 'smoothly peeling a boiled egg' is being recognised as a small, gratifying achievement.**
That moment when the shell comes away cleanly and easily, leaving a perfectly smooth surface, can bring a surprising mini-burst of satisfaction. No stubborn bits, just perfection!

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new kind of bread will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SQUEEZE TO CHECK FOR 'BOUNCE-BACK' OR SOFTNESS!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of honey, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A VERY SLOW, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF THE AROMA BEFORE OPENING!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you hear a particular 'everyday sound' that just instantly makes you feel cosy or nostalgic?**
  Perhaps it's the distant chimes of an ice cream van, the sound of rain on the window, or even a specific jingle from a TV advert. What everyday sound always makes you feel warm and fuzzy inside, and why?

- **We all have that 'one particular kitchen utensil' that, for some reason, we absolutely adore and couldn't do without, even if it's just a simple spoon or a trusty peeler.**
  What's that one essential kitchen item you cherish, and what makes it so special to you? Is it an old family hand-me-down, or just perfectly designed for the job?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called an 'array'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you tie a knot in a piece of string and throw it over your shoulder on a Saturday morning, it will bring you good luck for the rest of the weekend, especially if it lands on grass.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest; they have been observed at altitudes of over 9,000 metres.
- The 'richest' natural source of Vitamin C is the Australian Kakadu plum.
- The iconic 'red phone box' in the UK was designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, which is roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- A 'squircle' is a real geometric shape, a kind of intermediate between a square and a circle.
- The first recorded game of golf was played in Scotland in 1457.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SAT 24 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 297 of the year, 68 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthony Mary Claret; Christian feast day: Arethas of Najran; Christian feast day: Eberigisil (Evergitus); Christian feast day: Blessed Giuseppe Baldo. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1951 — George Tsontakis, American composer and conductor
- 1980 — Casey Wilson, American actress and screenwriter
- 1962 — Ian Dalziel, English footballer and manager
- 1947 — Kevin Kline, American actor and singer
- 1968 — Mark Walton, American voice actor and illustrator
- 1995 — Ashton Sanders, American actor
- 1994 — Krystal Jung, American-South Korean singer, dancer, and actress
- 1973 — Jackie McNamara, Scottish footballer and manager

THE DAY TODAY

- 2015 — A driver deliberately crashes into the Oklahoma State Homecoming parade, killing four people and injuring 34.
- 1947 — Famed animator Walt Disney testifies before the House Un-American Activities Committee, naming Disney employees he believes to be communists.
- 2016 — A French surveillance aircraft flying to Libya crashes on takeoff in Malta, killing all five people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2015 — A driver deliberately crashes into the Oklahoma State Homecoming parade, killing four people and injuring 34.
- 1975 — In Iceland, 90% of women take part in a national strike, refusing to work in protest of gender inequality.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — Chang'e 1, the first satellite in the Chinese Lunar Exploration Program, is launched from Xichang Satellite Launch Center.

- 1964 — Northern Rhodesia gains independence from the United Kingdom and becomes Zambia.
- 1960 — Nedelin catastrophe: An R-16 ballistic missile explodes on the launch pad at the Soviet Union's Baikonur Cosmodrome space facility, killing over 100 people, including Field Marshal Mitrofan Nedelin.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SUN 25 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 298 of the year, 67 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Romania); Christian feast day: Bernat Calbó (Bernard of Calvo); Christian feast day: Canna; Christian feast day: Blessed Carlo Gnocchi. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Michael Weston, American actor
- 1978 — Russell Anderson, Scottish footballer
- 1971 — Craig Robinson, American actor and singer
- 1988 — Lewis McGugan, English professional footballer
- 1946 — Peter Lieberson, American composer (died 2011)
- 1981 — Shaun Wright-Phillips, English footballer
- 1979 — Mariana Klaveno, American actress
- 1944 — Donald Ford, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1971 — The People's Republic of China replaces the Republic of China at the United Nations.
- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis: Adlai Stevenson shows the United Nations Security Council reconnaissance photographs of Soviet ballistic missiles in Cuba.
- 1990 — The Kazakh Soviet Socialist Republic declares its sovereignty from the Soviet Union.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1968 — A Fairchild F-27 crashes into Moose Mountain while on approach to Lebanon Municipal Airport in Lebanon, New Hampshire, killing 32 people.
- 2009 — The October 2009 Baghdad bombings kill 155 and wound at least 721.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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